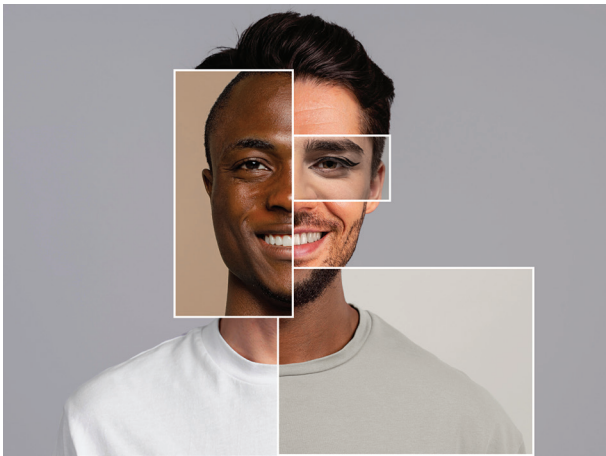




A practical starting structure might contain six compartments:

1. **Legal and financial:** Banking, tax, government, insurance, investments and regulated services.
2. **Professional:** Employer systems, professional networking, clients, industry events and job applications.
3. **Personal:** Friends, relatives, photographs, household services and everyday communication.
4. **Commercial:** Shopping, food delivery, travel offers, loyalty programmes, newsletters and product registrations.
5. **Public or creative:** Social media, publishing, streaming, community moderation or a pen name.
6. **Low-trust or exploratory:** Forums, trials, downloads, research and services you have not yet decided to trust.

These categories are flexible. A journalist may need source communication; a student may separate college accounts from independent projects. Create only as many compartments as you can maintain. Ten poorly managed identities are weaker than four clear ones.

Know when your real identity is required

Compartmentalisation does not eliminate lawful identification. Banking, telecom, taxation, employment and some regulated transactions may require accurate information. Supply truthful details where law or a legitimate contract requires them. The privacy decision is whether those verified identifiers must also be reused elsewhere.

A pseudonym is an alternate identifier, not a stolen identity. In India, Section 66C of the Information Technology Act addresses fraudulent or dishonest use of another person's electronic signature, password or other unique identification feature, while Section 66D addresses cheating by personation through a computer resource. Creating an original pen name is fundamentally different from taking a real person's photograph, credentials or reputation to deceive others.

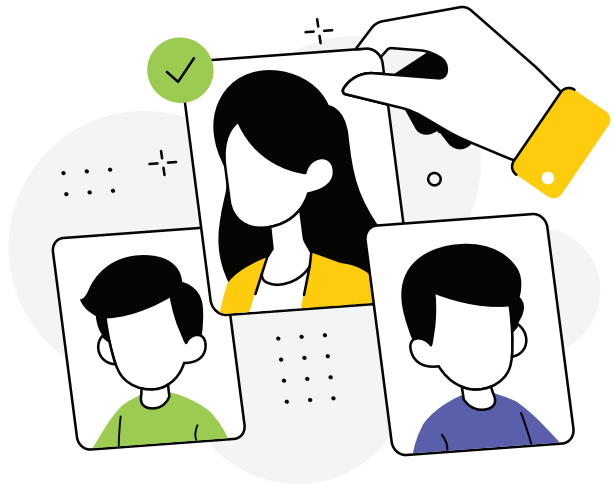
Platform rules may require information even when the law does not. Before creating a pseudonymous account, check whether pseudonyms, multiple accounts or professional names are permitted. Prefer less information, another service or no registration over lying.

Step 1: Build an identity map

Take a blank sheet or spreadsheet and create one column for every compartment. Under each, record:

- purpose;
- people or organisations that may know it;
- email address;
- phone number, if any;
- username pattern;
- profile photograph or avatar;
- browser profile;
- device or operating-system user;
- payment method;
- recovery method;
- information that may be shared;
- information that must never cross into it.

Next, draw arrows wherever two compartments already connect. Perhaps your shopping account uses your personal phone number. Your public creator account may recover through your professional email address. A gaming username may appear inside an old work biography. These arrows are your linkage points.



Mark each arrow as necessary, temporary or unnecessary. A bank using your legal phone number may be necessary. A trial application using your primary email is usually unnecessary. A recovery bridge may be temporarily acceptable until a safer recovery plan exists.

Do not sever everything immediately. Removing the only recovery method from an important account can leave you locked